LearnSync AI: AI Personalized Learning Companion for Grade 10 Students

A Capstone Project presented to the
College of Computer Studies of
Pamantasan ng Lungsod ng Pasig

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology

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CHAPTER I

THE PROBLEM AND ITS BACKGROUND

The rapid growth of digital learning has made independent study an important part of modern education. Students increasingly use digital learning applications such as review tools, flashcards, and quiz platforms to support lessons outside the classroom. However, many existing educational applications still rely on one-size-fits-all learning approaches, where the same learning activities and instructional materials are provided to all learners regardless of their individual learning progress or needs. Recent literature identifies personalized learning as a shift away from this traditional approach toward adaptive, learner-centered instruction (Fariani et al., 2023; Wang et al., 2025).

As a result, students may spend too much time reviewing concepts they already understand while receiving limited support for topics they find difficult. Learning activities that do not match students' knowledge and skill levels may also reduce engagement and contribute to boredom during independent study (Krannich et al., 2025). These challenges highlight the need for more personalized learning tools that can better address students' individual learning needs.

Cognitive Load Theory explains the limitations of one-size-fits-all learning tools by suggesting that students learn more effectively when instructional materials match their cognitive capacity. Therefore, digital learning platforms

should be designed to meet students' individual learning needs, since excessive, irrelevant, or poorly organized information can overload working memory and reduce learning effectiveness (Mayer, 2020).

Well-designed instructional materials reduce unnecessary cognitive load, helping students focus on understanding and remembering new information (Castro-Alonso et al., 2021). Similarly, digital learning environments that adapt to students' learning needs provide more effective and engaging learning experiences by reducing unrelated cognitive load (Skulmowski & Xu, 2022). These findings highlight the importance of designing educational technologies that personalize learning according to students' knowledge and learning progress.

Digital learning technologies have improved opportunities for independent learning by giving students flexible access to educational resources anytime and anywhere. Modern educational applications provide features such as digital quizzes, flashcards, note-taking tools, and learning analytics to support self-directed learning and encourage students to continue studying beyond the classroom (Viberg et al., 2020).

However, many existing educational applications focus on only specific learning activities instead of providing a complete learning environment. Therefore, students may rely on several non-integrated applications to support different learning needs. Research has shown that this fragmented use of multiple learning platforms can increase unrelated cognitive load and tool fatigue,

highlighting the importance of more integrated digital learning environments (Qiu & Qiu, 2026). Likewise, integrating learning activities and learning analytics within a single digital platform provides a more effective learning experience and better supports students' self-regulated learning (Pishtari et al., 2020). These findings suggest that although educational technology has improved opportunities for independent learning, there is still a need for more integrated and personalized learning platforms.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) has become a promising technology for improving digital learning platforms by providing personalized and adaptive learning experiences. Unlike traditional educational applications that use fixed learning activities, AI-powered systems can analyze students' learning progress, identify their strengths and weaknesses, and provide personalized learning paths, instructional content, and feedback based on their individual learning needs (Barrera Castro et al., 2024).

Recent research shows that AI-driven adaptive learning technologies improve learning experiences by adjusting instructional support based on students' performance and learning progress. This allows students to learn at their own pace while receiving personalized guidance (Bayly-Castaneda et al., 2024). These capabilities enable digital learning platforms to provide continuous and personalized support throughout the learning process, making learning more adaptive to each student's needs.

Pasig Christian Academy (PCA) is a private educational institution established in 1986 that offers Preschool, Elementary, and Junior High School education in Pasig City. The proposed system is intended for its Grade 10 students, who are preparing for the transition to Senior High School. Studies identify this transition as an important stage in the Philippine K–12 system, where students are expected to strengthen their academic readiness before moving to the more specialized Senior High School curriculum. Research also shows that Grade 10 students have varying levels of readiness in core subjects, highlighting the need for learning support that can better prepare them for Senior High School (Tactacon & Esparrago-Kalidas, 2026; Gorosin, 2025).

To address these challenges, the researchers propose LearnSync AI, an educational platform with AI integration designed to support the independent learning of Grade 10 students. The platform combines Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) and Generative Artificial Intelligence (Generative AI) to provide personalized learning experiences based on each student's estimated mastery. By combining adaptive learning technologies with AI-assisted learning support, LearnSync AI delivers personalized review materials, AI-assisted feedback, and adaptive learning activities based on each learner's estimated mastery. Through this approach, the platform aims to provide a more personalized and engaging independent learning experience than traditional one-size-fits-all review platforms.

LearnSync AI integrates multiple evidence-based learning strategies, adaptive learning technologies, and AI-assisted features into a single platform to

support independent learning. It provides a personalized learning analytics dashboard that displays mastery progress, study streaks, total study hours, digital badges, and performance statistics. Students can engage in AI-assisted learning strategies such as the Feynman Technique and Free Recall, where Generative AI provides personalized feedback and explanations to reinforce students' understanding during independent study. The platform also includes Adaptive Flashcards and Adaptive Test Mode, which continuously estimate students' mastery using Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT). To encourage consistent engagement, LearnSync AI features AI-generated educational games, including Crossword, Term Matching, and Timed Trivia, which use the learner's current mastery estimate to generate questions and adjust difficulty without modifying the underlying BKT mastery scores. In addition, the platform supports peer-to-peer resource sharing, allowing students to share flashcards, uploaded learning resources, adaptive test histories, and selected AI-generated study outputs within the learning community.

By combining adaptive learning with personalized AI feedback in a single platform, LearnSync AI provides students with learning activities that better match their estimated mastery and learning needs. Rather than relying on fixed review materials, the platform personalizes learning activities and feedback to support more effective and meaningful independent study.

Overall, LearnSync AI is proposed as an integrated educational platform that addresses the limitations of fragmented learning experiences and one-size-fits-all educational applications. By combining adaptive learning,

learning analytics, AI-assisted study strategies, and peer-to-peer resource sharing within a single system, the platform aims to provide Grade 10 students with a more personalized, integrated, and engaging environment for independent learning.

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE

This chapter presents a comprehensive synthesis of local and international literature, research studies, and technological frameworks relevant to the development of LearnSync AI.

Modern Study Challenges and Diverse Student Learners

Developing an effective digital learning platform requires recognizing that students differ in how they learn, process information, and respond to instruction. Learners vary in their prior knowledge, academic abilities, motivation, learning pace, and study strategies. Because of these differences, a single teaching approach may not effectively support all learners. Research on personalized education suggests that learning environments become more effective when they consider individual learner characteristics and provide appropriate support. Likewise, adaptive learning has been identified as an alternative to traditional

one-size-fits-all learning approaches by providing learning experiences that respond to individual learner needs and progress (Tetzlaff et al., 2021; Wang et al., 2025).

In addition, studies on adaptive learning emphasize that educational systems that respond to learners' needs and progress can create more engaging and effective learning experiences. (Plass & Pawar, 2020). As digital learning continues to expand, educational platforms are increasingly expected to provide flexible and personalized learning experiences that address the diverse needs of students.

Fast and Slow Learners

Students differ in the speed at which they process information, understand new concepts, and complete learning activities. These differences influence how learners respond to classroom instruction and digital learning environments. In mixed-ability classrooms, some students quickly master lessons and may become less engaged when instruction progresses too slowly, while others require additional time, practice, and guidance before fully understanding the material. Because learners have different academic needs, using the same teaching pace for everyone

may reduce engagement and limit learning opportunities for both high-performing and struggling students. Research on differentiated instruction suggests that learning environments should provide flexible support and varied learning opportunities to accommodate differences in students' abilities and learning pace (Ziernwald et al., 2022).

Likewise, research on educational differentiation indicates that adapting learning experiences to individual learner needs may improve participation, motivation, and academic achievement in diverse classrooms (Eikeland & Ohna, 2022). These findings highlight the importance of designing learning platforms that can support students at different levels of understanding rather than requiring all learners to progress at the same pace.

Study Preferences

Students have different preferences in how they manage their learning, with many relying on self-directed study to review lessons at their own pace and monitor their academic progress. Self-directed learning encourages learners to take responsibility for their education by selecting appropriate study materials, setting learning goals, and

evaluating their understanding. Research suggests that flexible digital learning environments can promote learner autonomy and support positive online learning experiences (Zhu et al., 2024).

In addition, students can benefit from sharing notes, reviewers, and other learning resources with their peers. Collaborative note-taking and shared learning materials allow learners to access different explanations, improve the completeness of study resources, and reduce cognitive load, leading to more effective learning (Costley & Fanguy, 2021). Therefore, digital learning platforms should support both independent study and educational resource sharing to accommodate diverse learning preferences and encourage continuous learning.

Digital Overload

The increasing use of digital technologies in education has created learning environments where students often rely on multiple digital tools and platforms to access learning materials, complete assessments, submit assignments, and communicate with instructors and classmates. Managing different interfaces and navigating

between separate systems can increase the mental effort required to perform learning tasks, leaving fewer cognitive resources available for understanding and retaining new information.

Research on digital learning suggests that unnecessary complexity in online learning environments contributes to unrelated cognitive load, which can reduce learning efficiency and make it more difficult for students to focus on instructional content (Skulmowski & Xu, 2021).

Furthermore, learning analytics research highlights the importance of designing well-organized digital learning environments that support students through efficient access to learning resources and educational activities, reducing unnecessary barriers to learning (Ifenthaler & Yau, 2020). These findings emphasize the value of developing integrated learning platforms that centralize educational resources and activities, providing students with a more organized and efficient learning experience.

Grade 10 Transition

Grade 10 represents the final stage of Junior High School and serves as an important period for preparing

students for the transition to Senior High School. During this stage, students are expected to strengthen their competencies in core subject areas and develop the academic readiness needed for more specialized Senior High School tracks. Research has shown that many Grade 10 students enter this transition with varying levels of readiness in English, Mathematics, Science, and inductive reasoning, highlighting the need for interventions that further strengthen their academic preparedness before entering Senior High School (Gorosin, 2025). Likewise, studies on Senior High School readiness emphasize that many learners still demonstrate gaps in essential academic competencies, making early interventions and personalized learning support important in helping students prepare for the increasing academic demands of Senior High School (Tactacon & Esparrago-Kalidas, 2026).

Independent learning plays a significant role in helping Grade 10 students reinforce classroom instruction and improve their readiness outside school hours. However, many conventional review methods still rely on a one-size-fits-all approach by providing the same learning materials and activities to all students regardless of their current understanding or learning progress. Research

suggests that adaptive educational technologies provide a more personalized alternative by adjusting learning activities according to students' performance and providing targeted feedback (Suntharalingam, 2024; Wang et al., 2025). These findings justify selecting Grade 10 students as the target users of LearnSync AI, since they are at a critical stage where personalized review and independent learning support can help reinforce core competencies before entering Senior High School.

The reviewed literature demonstrates that students differ in their learning pace, study preferences, and academic readiness, highlighting the importance of providing personalized support during independent learning. Existing educational applications often focus on isolated learning activities or static review methods, requiring students to use multiple platforms while providing limited adaptation to individual learning needs. These limitations indicate a need for an integrated learning environment that combines evidence-based learning strategies with adaptive support in a single platform.

Guided by these findings, LearnSync AI is designed to address these research gaps by integrating personalized learning, learning analytics, adaptive review, AI-assisted study strategies, gamified learning

activities, and peer-to-peer resource sharing into one unified educational platform. By continuously adapting learning experiences according to students' estimated mastery while providing diverse learning strategies within a single system, the platform aims to support Grade 10 students' independent learning and strengthen their academic readiness for the transition to Senior High School.

Analysis of Independent Study Tools and Research Gaps

Independent study tools have become an important part of modern education by providing students with flexible ways to review lessons and learn outside the classroom. Various digital learning applications offer features such as flashcards, quizzes, note-taking, and progress tracking to support self-directed learning (Viberg et al., 2020). Although these tools have expanded access to learning resources, many educational applications continue to focus on specific learning activities rather than providing a comprehensive learning environment. Therefore, students may rely on different applications to support different aspects of their learning, resulting in a fragmented digital learning experience (Qiu & Qiu, 2026).

Research emphasizes that effective digital learning environments should integrate learning activities and minimize

unnecessary cognitive demands so that students can focus on learning instead of navigating multiple technologies (Skulmowski & Xu, 2022). These observations reveal research gaps in existing independent study tools, particularly in integrating multiple evidence-based learning methods and providing adaptive support within a single platform.

Fragmentation of Current Educational Applications

Educational applications have become widely used to support independent learning by providing digital tools such as flashcards, quizzes, note-taking, and progress tracking. However, many educational applications continue to emphasize specific learning activities instead of providing a fully integrated learning environment. Consequently, students often use multiple digital platforms to support different learning tasks, creating a fragmented learning experience. Recent research found that the use of multiple, non-integrated learning platforms can increase unrelated cognitive load and tool fatigue, making it more difficult for students to focus on learning (Qiu & Qiu, 2026).

Likewise, research on digital learning environments emphasizes that well-integrated learning systems reduce

unnecessary cognitive demands and provide more effective learning experiences by allowing learners to focus on learning rather than navigating different technologies (Skulmowski & Xu, 2022).

Studies on learning design also highlight the importance of integrating learning activities and analytics within a unified environment to better support students' learning processes and self-regulated learning (Pishtari et al., 2020). These findings suggest that educational platforms should integrate multiple evidence-based learning methods into a single system to provide a more seamless and personalized independent learning experience.

Limitations of Static Review Systems

Many educational applications continue to rely on static review systems, where students receive the same learning materials and review activities regardless of their individual progress or level of understanding. These systems often present fixed quizzes, flashcards, or review sessions without considering students' strengths, weaknesses, or mastery of different topics. As a result, learners may spend too much time reviewing concepts they already understand

while receiving insufficient practice on topics they find difficult.

Research on personalized learning has shown that adaptive learning environments improve the learning experience by adjusting instructional content and learning activities according to students' individual needs, learning pace, and performance (Bernacki et al., 2021). Likewise, adaptive content recommendation systems provide personalized learning resources based on learner characteristics, helping students receive more appropriate learning support than traditional one-size-fits-all review methods (Raj & Renumol, 2022). These findings suggest that static review systems have limitations in supporting personalized learning and highlight the importance of adaptive educational technologies.

The reviewed literature demonstrates that fragmented educational applications and static review systems present challenges to independent learning by increasing unnecessary cognitive demands and limiting opportunities for personalized instruction. Although existing educational applications effectively support specific learning activities, few integrate

multiple evidence-based learning methods with adaptive learning technologies within a single platform.

Guided by these findings, LearnSync AI is designed to address these research gaps by integrating evidence-based learning strategies, adaptive artificial intelligence, gamification, learning analytics, and peer-to-peer resource sharing into a unified learning environment. Through this, the platform aims to provide Grade 10 students with a more personalized, integrated, and engaging independent learning experience.

Learning Analytics and Student Motivation

Learning analytics has become an important tool in modern education by providing students with real-time information about their learning progress. Traditionally, educational data such as grades and assessment results were primarily used by teachers to monitor student performance. However, modern learning platforms now present this information directly to students through learner-facing dashboards, allowing them to track their own progress and identify areas that require further study (Matcha et al., 2020; Valle et al., 2021). By giving students access to their own learning data, these systems promote self-regulated learning, where learners actively monitor, evaluate, and regulate their learning strategies.

Research has shown that learner-facing dashboards increase students' awareness of their academic progress, support self-regulated learning, and improve motivation by helping learners visualize their achievements and learning goals (Aguilar et al., 2021; Paulsen & Lindsay, 2024). Rather than feeling uncertain about their progress, students can make informed decisions about what to review and which topics require additional study. Collectively, these studies highlight the value of integrating learner-facing analytics into digital learning platforms to support students' motivation, self-regulated learning, and academic progress.

Mastery Progress

Visualizing mastery progress helps students monitor their learning by showing their current level of understanding and progress toward learning goals. Unlike traditional grading systems, which often provide feedback after assessments, learner-facing dashboards allow students to monitor their progress continuously. This helps them identify their strengths and the topics that require further study while developing metacognitive skills such as monitoring and reflecting on their own learning (Matcha et al., 2020).

Research has shown that learner-facing dashboards help students monitor their progress, evaluate their learning strategies, and set learning goals (Valle et al., 2021). In addition, providing students with access to their learning data increases their awareness of their academic performance and encourages them to take greater responsibility for their own learning (Aguilar et al., 2021). Collectively, these findings suggest that visualizing mastery progress is an effective way to support independent learning, strengthen students' metacognitive skills, and improve engagement with their studies.

Study Consistency and Behavioral Engagement

Study streaks and digital badges are features that encourage students to develop consistent learning habits by recognizing their regular participation and achievements. A study streak records the number of consecutive days a student completes learning activities, while digital badges acknowledge milestones such as completing lessons or reaching learning goals.These features provide continuous feedback and recognition that can motivate students to

remain engaged and participate consistently in learning activities (Sailer & Homner, 2020).

Research has shown that consistent engagement and self-monitoring help students develop self-regulated learning skills and improve their persistence in completing learning activities (Matcha et al., 2020). Learning analytics studies also indicate that monitoring students' behavioral engagement helps promote active participation and supports improved learning performance by encouraging consistent involvement in learning activities (Johar et al., 2023).

In addition, achievement indicators such as digital badges have been found to increase learner engagement and encourage continued participation when they are linked to meaningful learning goals and progress (Tahir et al., 2022). Collectively, these findings suggest that study streaks and digital badges can promote consistent learning habits, strengthen learner engagement, and support regular participation in independent learning.

Time-on-Task and Self-Regulated Learning

Time-on-task refers to the amount of time students spend completing learning activities. In digital learning

environments, tracking and displaying study time helps students monitor their learning habits and become more aware of how they manage their time. Unlike traditional learning environments, where students' independent study time is often difficult to monitor, digital platforms provide real-time information that allows learners to evaluate their study pace and identify whether they are spending enough time on their lessons (Hilliger et al., 2021).

Research has shown that monitoring learning behaviors, including time spent on learning activities, supports self-regulated learning by encouraging students to plan, monitor, and reflect on their learning process (Lim et al., 2021). In addition, learning analytics that visualize study behaviors help students become more aware of their learning progress and encourage them to take greater responsibility for their own learning (Aguilar et al., 2021). These findings suggest that displaying time-on-task information can promote greater responsibility for learning, support independent learning, and encourage students to develop effective study habits.

The reviewed literature demonstrates that providing students with direct access to their own learning data supports motivation and self-regulated learning by helping learners monitor their progress and study behaviors. Features such as visualizing mastery progress, tracking study time, and using gamified rewards like streaks and badges help learners build consistent study habits and monitor their own performance. These tools are especially important for students who need to manage their time and identify their own weaknesses during unsupervised study.

Guided by these findings, LearnSync AI features a personalized learning analytics dashboard designed to support Grade 10 students during their independent studies. The platform centralizes their educational data by displaying real-time mastery progress, total study hours, study streaks, and digital badges. By transforming students' learning activities into clear, visual feedback, the platform encourages them to take greater responsibility for their own learning, maintain consistent study routines, and actively monitor their academic progress without requiring continuous teacher supervision.

Using Artificial Intelligence for Personalized Student Support

Artificial Intelligence has become an important component of modern educational systems by providing personalized support that addresses the diverse learning needs of students. Traditional

learning approaches often rely on fixed instructional materials that do not adapt to individual differences in learning pace, prior knowledge, or performance. In contrast, AI-based educational systems can analyze student performance and learning behaviors to personalize instructional content, provide timely feedback, and recommend learning activities based on individual progress (Chen et al., 2020). By adapting learning experiences to each student's needs, AI has the potential to improve student engagement, promote deeper understanding, and support more effective learning outcomes.

Beyond personalizing learning content, AI can also provide continuous academic support by offering personalized feedback, recommending appropriate learning activities, and identifying areas where students need additional practice or guidance. Unlike traditional educational platforms that present the same content to all learners, AI-powered systems can respond to individual learning needs by adjusting learning support based on students' progress and performance. This personalized approach enables students to learn at their own pace while receiving timely assistance that strengthens their understanding and encourages continuous learning (Chen et al., 2020).

AI in Modern Classrooms

The integration of Artificial Intelligence in modern classrooms has played an important role in shifting traditional educational approaches toward more flexible and adaptive learning environments. Historically, many learning systems have followed a one-size-fits-all approach in which students receive the same lessons and review materials regardless of their individual abilities, learning pace, or level of understanding. In contrast, AI-based educational systems can analyze student interactions and performance data to personalize instructional content according to individual learning needs (Chen et al., 2020).

These systems provide personalized feedback, adjust task difficulty, and recommend learning activities based on each student's current level of understanding, allowing learners to receive appropriate support throughout the learning process (Murtaza et al., 2022). This adaptive capability enables students to learn at their own pace while improving engagement, learning efficiency, and independent study.

AI in Finding Student Learning Gaps

Artificial Intelligence has become an important tool for identifying students' learning gaps and providing personalized academic support. Traditional assessment methods often rely on periodic tests and evaluations, which may not immediately identify areas where students are struggling. In contrast, AI-driven adaptive learning systems can continuously analyze students' learning behaviors and performance data to identify concepts that require additional practice or support (Strielkowski et al., 2024).

By monitoring students' progress throughout the learning process, these systems can provide timely feedback and recommend appropriate learning activities based on individual needs. This enables students to recognize their learning gaps, focus on areas that need improvement, and develop a stronger understanding of concepts while studying independently.

The reviewed literature highlights the important role of Artificial Intelligence in enhancing education by providing personalized learning experiences, adapting instructional content based on students' performance, and identifying learning gaps that require additional support.

These capabilities address the limitations of traditional learning approaches, which often provide the same learning experience to all students regardless of their individual needs and progress.

Guided by these findings, LearnSync AI integrates Artificial Intelligence to deliver adaptive and personalized academic support for Grade 10 students. By continuously adjusting learning activities according to students' progress and identifying areas that require reinforcement, the platform promotes more effective independent learning and encourages deeper conceptual understanding. Through this adaptive approach, LearnSync AI aims to provide a responsive learning environment that improves student engagement, strengthens knowledge retention, and supports better learning progress.

Combining Gamification and Evidence-Based Learning Strategies

Modern digital learning platforms increasingly combine multiple instructional approaches to support different aspects of student learning. Gamification enhances motivation and engagement by incorporating game elements that encourage active participation and sustained learning (Sailer & Homner, 2020).

At the same time, evidence-based cognitive learning strategies, particularly retrieval practice, strengthen understanding, memory, and long-term knowledge retention by encouraging

learners to actively recall previously learned information (Agarwal et al., 2021). Rather than serving the same purpose, these approaches complement one another by addressing different learning needs.

Recent systematic reviews suggest that well-designed gamified learning environments are most effective when game elements are integrated with sound instructional strategies that promote meaningful learning rather than functioning as isolated activities (Dehghanzadeh et al., 2024). These findings support the integration of gamification and evidence-based learning strategies within a single digital learning platform to provide engaging and meaningful learning experiences.

Gamification Procedures

Gamification has become an effective teaching approach that improves student engagement, motivation, and learning by incorporating game elements into educational activities. Unlike traditional study methods that rely mainly on reading or memorization, gamified learning encourages students to participate actively through interactive challenges, immediate feedback, and achievable goals. Studies have shown that gamification can enhance

students' motivation, engagement, and learning experiences (Sailer & Homner, 2020).

In digital learning platforms, gamified learning activities provide learners with interactive opportunities to review previously learned concepts while maintaining motivation during independent study. By integrating game elements with educational objectives, these activities encourage active participation and sustained engagement rather than functioning only as entertainment. Systematic reviews have shown that well-designed gamification supports meaningful learning experiences by increasing learners' motivation and participation when aligned with sound instructional strategies (Sailer & Homner, 2020; Dehghanzadeh et al., 2024).

Crossword

Crossword puzzles have become a useful educational activity for reinforcing knowledge and improving students' understanding of key concepts. Unlike traditional review methods that rely only on reading or memorization, crossword puzzles encourage learners to actively recall information by

identifying and connecting terms with their corresponding definitions or clues. This process promotes deeper cognitive engagement while making learning more interactive and enjoyable.

Research suggests that crossword puzzles can improve students' understanding of key concepts and support better performance in objective assessments by encouraging active recall during learning activities (Arnold et al., 2024). These findings suggest that incorporating crossword puzzles into digital learning platforms can strengthen concept retention while increasing student engagement during independent study.

Matching Card Games

Matching card games are widely used as interactive learning activities that promote active participation and reinforce students' understanding of concepts. By requiring learners to match related terms, definitions, images, or concepts, these activities encourage active recall and strengthen

associations between pieces of information rather than relying on passive reading.

Recent research found that matching card-based learning materials significantly improved students' vocabulary mastery and learning outcomes by providing an engaging and interactive learning experience (Febrianti & Shofiyuddin, 2025). Because matching activities encourage learners to repeatedly recall and associate related concepts, their underlying principles can be adapted to reinforce foundational knowledge in digital learning environments.

Timed Trivia Questions

Timed trivia questions are an effective gamified learning activity that combines retrieval practice with interactive quiz-based learning. By requiring learners to answer review questions within a limited time, students actively retrieve information from memory while maintaining focus under structured time constraints. This transforms conventional review sessions into engaging learning experiences that encourage continuous participation and immediate

feedback. A literature review found that game-based quiz platforms such as Kahoot! consistently improve student engagement, motivation, classroom participation, and learning performance across different educational settings (Wang & Tahir, 2020).

In addition, the integration of game elements such as time limits, scores, and immediate feedback has been shown to positively influence learners' motivation and academic outcomes when appropriately incorporated into educational activities (Sailer & Homner, 2020). Together, these findings suggest that timed trivia questions provide an engaging review strategy that encourages active participation while reinforcing previously learned concepts through repeated retrieval practice.

Retrieval Practices

Cognitive retrieval practices are an important component of modern educational psychology that enhance how students recall and retain learned information. Unlike traditional study methods that rely on rereading or passive memorization, retrieval-based learning requires students to

actively recall information from memory, which strengthens long-term retention and improves understanding of concepts. Research has consistently shown that retrieval practice is more effective than passive review strategies in improving learning and long-term retention (Agarwal et al., 2021).

In addition, testing-based learning has been found to significantly enhance classroom learning by improving memory retention and reinforcing conceptual understanding over time (Yang et al., 2021). Retrieval practice can be implemented through learning strategies such as free recall and structured explanation exercises, including the Feynman Technique, which encourage learners to actively reconstruct knowledge from memory.

Feynman Technique

The Feynman Technique is a learning strategy that helps students develop a deeper understanding of concepts by explaining lessons in their own words using simple and clear language. Rather than relying on memorization, learners actively recall information, identify gaps in their understanding, and revisit concepts until they can explain them accurately. This

process encourages students to organize and connect ideas, promoting meaningful learning instead of rote memorization.

Research on generative learning suggests that explanation-based learning helps students construct knowledge by organizing information, connecting new ideas with prior knowledge, and actively generating explanations. These learning processes strengthen conceptual understanding, support long-term retention, and encourage learners to monitor their own understanding throughout the learning process (Fiorella, 2023). Likewise, Reyes et al. (2021) found that students who practiced explaining concepts in simple language demonstrated better conceptual understanding than those who used traditional study methods. These findings suggest that the Feynman Technique is an effective cognitive learning strategy for supporting comprehension, identifying knowledge gaps, and promoting independent learning.

Free Recall

Free recall is a form of retrieval practice that helps students strengthen their memory by encouraging them to remember and explain what they have learned without using notes or other learning materials. Instead of simply rereading information, students actively retrieve knowledge from memory, making it easier to identify topics they understand and concepts that require further review. This process improves understanding and supports long-term retention (Yang et al., 2021).

Research has shown that retrieval practice, including free recall, is more effective than passive study methods such as rereading for improving learning and memory (Agarwal et al., 2021; Yang et al., 2021). Actively recalling information improves memory, strengthens understanding, and supports deeper understanding and long-term retention. (Agarwal et al., 2021). Likewise, retrieval-based learning helps students retain information longer and reinforces their understanding of lesson concepts (Yang et al., 2021). These findings suggest that free recall is an effective cognitive learning strategy for supporting students' independent learning.

Adaptive Flashcards

Flashcards are widely used as a learning tool that supports active recall and improves memory retention. Unlike passive study methods such as rereading notes, flashcards require learners to actively retrieve information from memory, which strengthens understanding and reinforces learned concepts. Research on vocabulary learning has shown that intentional use of flashcards can significantly improve recall performance and learning outcomes compared to traditional study methods such as word lists and repeated reading (Webb et al., 2020).

In addition, studies on digital and mobile-assisted learning indicate that flashcards are effective in supporting vocabulary acquisition and improving students' retention of academic words when used as part of structured study activities (Xodabande et al., 2022). The effectiveness of flashcards can be further enhanced when combined with spaced repetition principles, where review sessions are scheduled at increasing intervals based on learner performance.

Modern adaptive learning systems further improve this process by using data-driven approaches to personalize

review schedules. Unlike static study methods where learners may repeatedly review familiar material or neglect difficult concepts, adaptive flashcard systems adjust the frequency of review based on student performance. These systems help optimize learning efficiency by focusing more on challenging items and reducing unnecessary repetition, which can improve long-term retention and reduce cognitive load (Huang, 2025).

Adaptive Assessment

Computerized adaptive testing has become an important development in modern educational assessment, shifting traditional fixed testing formats toward more flexible and data-driven evaluation systems. Unlike conventional assessments where all students answer the same set of questions regardless of ability, adaptive testing systems adjust question difficulty based on learners' responses and performance patterns. Recent research highlights that these systems use real-time performance data and machine learning techniques to select appropriate test items, allowing assessments to better match each student's level of understanding (Zhuang et al., 2024).

In addition, AI-driven quiz generation systems have been shown to support the creation of dynamic assessments that can adjust question difficulty and provide more personalized evaluation experiences (Al-Gburi, 2025). Through these adaptive mechanisms, computerized testing systems aim to improve the efficiency of assessments and provide more accurate representations of student knowledge and learning progress.

The reviewed literature suggests that integrating gamification, retrieval-based learning strategies, flashcards, and adaptive assessment can contribute to more effective and engaging learning experiences compared to traditional passive study methods. Gamification has been shown to enhance student motivation and engagement by incorporating interactive and goal-oriented learning activities, while cognitive strategies such as active recall and retrieval practice support deeper understanding and long-term retention of information. Similarly, adaptive flashcards reinforce learning through repeated exposure and retrieval of information, which helps strengthen memory and improve recall over time. In addition, adaptive assessment approaches improve learning efficiency by adjusting the difficulty and content of evaluation tasks based on student performance, allowing learners to be assessed according to their current level of understanding.

Collectively, these approaches highlight the value of combining motivational and cognitive learning strategies within digital learning environments. Guided by these findings, LearnSync AI integrates gamification, retrieval-based learning strategies, adaptive flashcards, and adaptive assessments into a unified platform that supports personalized, adaptive, and self-directed learning. Through this integrated approach, the platform aims to promote student engagement, reinforce knowledge retention, and support independent learning.

Performance Evaluation of Language Models and Inference Systems

The performance of large language models and their inference systems is an important factor in ensuring that AI-powered educational platforms provide fast, reliable, and responsive learning experiences. In digital learning environments, delays in processing user inputs or generating responses can negatively affect student engagement and disrupt learning continuity. As a result, modern LLM systems are designed with optimized inference and serving architectures that improve how models handle multiple user requests efficiently. Research on distributed model serving systems shows that optimized inference techniques can improve system throughput and response efficiency in transformer-based language models (Yu et al., 2022).

In addition, studies on memory-efficient LLM serving highlight that improved resource management and computational optimization help reduce latency and support smoother real-time interactions in large-scale AI applications (Kwon et al., 2023). These advancements are particularly important for educational platforms that rely on generative AI, as they ensure timely feedback, stable performance, and uninterrupted learning support for users.

LLM in Materials and Context

The use of large language models (LLMs) in educational systems plays an important role in improving how students interact with complex and lengthy learning materials. Early transformer-based language models demonstrated strong capabilities in understanding and generating human-like text, enabling flexible language processing across a wide range of inputs (Brown et al., 2020).

While earlier transformer-based language models were limited by relatively restrictive context windows that affected continuity in multi-topic interactions, recent advancements in large language models have significantly

improved their ability to process longer contextual inputs. These improvements allow models to generate more coherent and context-aware responses when working with extended learning materials. As a result, when integrated into educational platforms, LLM-based systems can better support student understanding of complex topics by providing more consistent and contextually relevant explanations during independent study (Sharma et al., 2025).

Real Time Feedback

Large language model–based systems play an important role in providing immediate formative feedback within digital learning environments. In traditional systems, delays in generating responses may interrupt students' focus during active learning tasks such as retrieval practice and review activities. In contrast, modern AI-powered systems are capable of delivering near real-time feedback and personalized guidance, which supports student engagement and sustained participation in learning activities (Kasneci et al., 2023).

Reducing response delays also helps create a smoother interaction between the learner and the system, minimizing disruption during study sessions. This immediate feedback allows students to quickly identify and correct mistakes, which can improve learning efficiency, task engagement, and revision behavior (Meyer et al., 2024).

Model Specialization and Dynamic Routing

The use of multiple large language models within a single system plays an important role in improving the efficiency and responsiveness of AI-powered applications. Instead of relying on a single model to handle all types of tasks, modern systems can distribute requests by assigning them to different models based on task complexity and computational requirements. Research on LLM routing systems shows that queries can be directed to different models depending on expected performance needs, allowing systems to balance quality and efficiency (Ong et al., 2024).

In this approach, simpler or less computationally demanding tasks can be handled by more efficient models, while more complex requests are processed by higher-capacity models. This routing strategy helps optimize

system performance by reducing unnecessary computational load and improving response time, resulting in a smoother and more efficient user experience in real-time applications.

The reviewed studies demonstrate that an effective AI-powered educational platform depends not only on the capabilities of large language models but also on efficient inference systems, real-time feedback, contextual understanding, and appropriate task distribution among AI components. Together, these technologies create a learning environment that is responsive, reliable, and capable of supporting students throughout their independent study sessions.

Guided by these findings, LearnSync AI integrates these concepts to provide fast AI-generated assistance, process lengthy study materials effectively, deliver immediate personalized feedback, and maintain smooth system performance. By combining this into a unified application, it provides Grade 10 students with a more efficient, engaging, and personalized learning experience that supports independent study and improves overall learning outcomes.

Bayesian Knowledge Tracing

Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) is a probabilistic model used in intelligent tutoring systems to estimate a learner's mastery of specific skills based on their sequence of correct and incorrect responses. It works by continuously updating the probability that a student has learned a concept, making it useful for modeling knowledge progression in adaptive learning environments. BKT is commonly used in educational systems due to its simplicity, interpretability, and ability to support dynamic learner modeling without requiring high computational complexity (Bulut et al., 2023).

Recent implementations such as pyBKT further demonstrate its practicality by providing accessible tools for applying BKT models in educational research and learning systems (Badrinath et al., 2021). Although more complex models exist, BKT remains widely used in many educational contexts because it offers an effective balance between computational efficiency and meaningful learner tracking, making it suitable for adaptive learning applications.

Tracking Models: BKT, DKT, and PFA

In educational data mining, predicting student learning progression involves modeling hidden knowledge states using

different algorithmic approaches, including Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT), Performance Factors Analysis (PFA), and Deep Knowledge Tracing (DKT) (Abdelrahman et al., 2022). These models vary in structure and complexity. BKT is a probabilistic model that estimates student mastery based on sequential performance, while PFA is a statistical approach that predicts learning outcomes by considering the cumulative count of prior successes and failures in skill practice. In contrast, DKT utilizes deep learning techniques to model complex learning patterns from large-scale datasets.

Research indicates that deep learning-based approaches such as DKT can achieve strong predictive performance, particularly when large datasets are available, but they may introduce challenges related to interpretability compared to traditional models (Scruggs et al., 2020). Meanwhile, BKT and PFA remain widely used in educational systems due to their simplicity, interpretability, and lower computational requirements, making them suitable for applications that require transparent learner modeling. These differences highlight the trade-offs between predictive accuracy, interpretability, and computational complexity when selecting knowledge tracing models for educational applications

BKT Selection

Among the different knowledge tracing models reviewed, including Performance Factors Analysis (PFA) and Deep Knowledge Tracing (DKT), the researchers selected Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) as the learner modeling approach for the system. This decision is based on its suitability for adaptive learning environments that require efficient, interpretable, and sequential tracking of student knowledge.

Unlike DKT, which requires large datasets and higher computational resources, and PFA, which focuses on aggregated performance counts rather than step-by-step learning progression, BKT provides a lightweight framework that updates learner mastery based on individual responses. Its simplicity and transparency make it appropriate for educational applications where clear interpretation of student progress is important. Therefore, BKT was chosen to support the system's need for continuous, real-time, and interpretable tracking of learner performance in adaptive learning activities such as flashcards and assessments.

BKT Parameters

The Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) framework operates using four key and interpretable parameters that are used to

estimate a learner's knowledge state after each interaction (Badrinath et al., 2021; Bulut et al., 2023). These include two learning-related parameters namely *prior knowledge,* which represents the probability that a student has already mastered a skill before interacting with the system, and the *learning rate,* which indicates the probability that a student acquires the skill after a learning opportunity.

In addition, BKT incorporates two performance-related parameters namely the *guess probability*, which accounts for the likelihood that a student answers correctly despite not having mastered the concept, and the *slip probability*, which captures the chance of an incorrect response despite the student having already learned the skill. These parameters allow BKT to more accurately model student learning behavior by distinguishing true understanding from random or careless responses.

The integration of BKT into LearnSync AI provides a highly efficient method for tracking student mastery during independent study sessions. By continuously updating a learner's knowledge state based on their real-time responses, the system can accurately estimate skill mastery while accounting for random errors such as guessing or slipping. Relying

on this lightweight tracking infrastructure ensures that the application remains fast and responsive.

Finally, leveraging BKT enables LearnSync AI to effectively personalize learning activities, dynamically adjust difficulty levels, and provide immediate adaptive feedback, resulting in a highly individualized educational experience.

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE STUDY

This study is significant because it proposes LearnSync AI to provide personalized and adaptive learning for Grade 10 students. The proposed system is expected to benefit the following:

Pasig Christian Academy. The proposed system will benefit Pasig Christian Academy by providing a centralized learning platform that supports students' independent learning. Through LearnSync AI, the school can offer AI-assisted study methods, personalized review, learning progress tracking, and peer-to-peer resource sharing within a single platform. This may encourage technology-enhanced learning and strengthen the school's commitment to innovative educational practices.

Educators. The proposed system will benefit educators by providing a supplementary learning tool that students can use outside the classroom.

Through AI-assisted learning, adaptive review, and personalized study activities, students can reinforce their understanding of lessons independently. This enables educators to complement classroom instruction by encouraging students to continue learning beyond regular class hours.

Students. The proposed system will provide students with a personalized study companion that adapts learning activities according to their estimated mastery. Instead of relying on generic review materials, students can use adaptive flashcards, AI-assisted feedback, gamified learning activities, and peer resource sharing to support independent learning and make review sessions more engaging.

Grade 10 Students. The proposed system is specifically designed for Grade 10 students as they prepare for the transition to Senior High School. By providing personalized review activities, adaptive learning, and AI-assisted feedback based on each learner's estimated mastery, LearnSync AI supports independent learning and provides personalized review of core lessons as students prepare for Senior High School.

Researchers. The study will help the researchers enhance their knowledge and skills in software development, educational technology, artificial intelligence, adaptive learning systems, and Bayesian Knowledge Tracing. It will also provide valuable experience in designing, developing, implementing, and evaluating an AI-powered educational platform.

Future Researchers. This study may serve as a reference for future researchers who intend to develop AI-powered educational platforms. It may also provide a foundation for enhancing adaptive learning features, integrating emerging AI technologies, and expanding personalized learning systems for different educational levels and contexts.

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

While Pasig Christian Academy aims to improve education for Grade 10 students, many still rely on generic and disconnected study applications that make independent learning less personalized and efficient. Research suggests that Artificial Intelligence (AI) can address these challenges by providing adaptive learning experiences tailored to individual learner needs (Kasneci et al., 2023; Tlili et al., 2023). To address this problem, the researchers propose LearnSync AI, an educational platform that combines Generative AI and Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) to support personalized learning.

This study seeks to evaluate the platform's technical accuracy, support for independent learning, user engagement, and overall acceptability through the following research questions:

1. What are the existing challenges encountered by Grade 10 students in traditional learning environments that can be addressed through LearnSync AI?

2. How accurately does LearnSync AI utilize Generative Artificial Intelligence and Bayesian Knowledge Tracing to personalize learning content and algorithmic outputs?

3. What is the perceived effectiveness of LearnSync AI in promoting Grade 10 students' engagement and supporting independent learning through its AI-assisted learning, adaptive methods, gamification, and peer-to-peer resource sharing features?

4. What is the level of acceptability of LearnSync AI based on the ISO/IEC 25010 software quality characteristics as evaluated by Grade 10 students?

SCOPE AND LIMITATIONS

The research focuses on the design, development, and evaluation of LearnSync AI as an AI-powered educational platform that integrates personalized learning, AI-assisted study strategies, gamification, learning analytics, and peer-to-peer resource sharing.

Scope of the Study:

This study focuses on the engineering, development, and validation of LearnSync AI, a responsive web application evaluated using the ISO/IEC 25010 software quality standards for Functional Suitability, Usability, Performance Efficiency, and Security. System implementation and evaluation are limited to 18 Grade 10 students from Pasig Christian Academy during the Academic Year 2026–2027. The platform allows students to upload standard secondary education modules as plain-text PDF files with a maximum file size of 20 MB into a digital learning repository.

Central to the platform is the classical four-parameter Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) algorithm, which estimates students' mastery based on their performance in Adaptive Flashcards and Adaptive Test Mode.These mastery estimates are used to personalize the question selection and difficulty of AI-generated educational games, including Crossword, Term

Matching, and Timed Trivia. The platform also provides AI-assisted learning through the Feynman Technique and Free Recall, where Generative AI delivers personalized feedback and explanations to reinforce students' understanding and support independent learning.

In addition, the platform includes a peer-to-peer collaboration feature that enables students to share custom flashcard sets, uploaded learning resources, and read-only study session histories with their classmates. Shared resources are accessible only to authorized users within the platform to support collaborative and independent learning.

Limitations of the Study:

To maintain the project's feasibility and scope, several limitations are established. System implementation and evaluation are restricted to a 2- to 4-week period, preventing the measurement of long-term knowledge retention, sustained learning behaviors, or long-term learning outcomes. Technically, the system experiences an algorithmic cold start whenever a new learning module is uploaded. An initial set of assessment items is required to establish a baseline mastery estimate before adaptive learning can begin. The AI component is designed exclusively for standard Junior High

School core subjects and is not intended for tertiary-level or highly specialized professional content.

The platform exclusively employs the classical Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) model, where mastery estimates are updated only through Adaptive Flashcards and Adaptive Test Mode. AI-generated educational games use the learner's current mastery estimate only to personalize question selection, generated content, and difficulty without modifying the underlying mastery scores. without modifying the underlying mastery scores. Likewise, the Feynman Technique and Free Recall function as AI-assisted learning strategies that provide explanations and feedback but do not update or influence BKT mastery estimates. This design ensures that learner mastery is based solely on assessment performance. The peer-to-peer collaboration feature is limited to sharing learning resources, custom flashcard sets, and read-only study session histories. Students cannot edit or delete resources owned by other users, and the platform does not provide real-time messaging, group discussions, or collaborative document editing.

Operationally, the application requires a stable internet connection and accepts only plain-text PDF files with a maximum file size of 20 MB. It does not support offline functionality, voice-based interactions, or handwritten text recognition. The platform also excludes commercial features such as payment

gateways, automated billing, and enterprise-level server auto-scaling. Finally, the study complies with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173) by collecting only the information necessary for system operation and protecting the confidentiality of student data. No highly sensitive personal information is collected, and student data is not shared with third parties.

CHAPTER II

INTRODUCTION

This chapter presents the methodology used to design, develop, and evaluate LearnSync AI: AI Personalized Learning Companion for Grade 10 Students. This web-based platform is created exclusively for Grade 10 students to support in their independent learning. The sections in this chapter detail the system's technical design, development workflows, algorithms, and data structures that allow the platform to operate safely, securely, and efficiently.

The application is designed with a single user role, the student, to provide a focused and personalized learning experience. Students can upload their own learning materials, access AI-assisted learning strategies such as the Feynman Technique and Free Recall, complete Adaptive Flashcards and Adaptive Test Mode, participate in AI-generated educational games, monitor their learning progress through the analytics dashboard, and share selected learning resources with classmates. Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) continuously estimates each student's mastery based on their performance in Adaptive Flashcards and Adaptive Test Mode, while the resulting mastery estimates are used to personalize the difficulty of AI-generated educational games.

Finally, this chapter describes the system implementation and evaluation procedures. A 2- to 4-week implementation and user evaluation will be conducted at Pasig Christian Academy with 18 Grade 10 students serving as the study participants. User feedback will be collected using an evaluation instrument

based on the ISO/IEC 25010 software quality model to assess the platform's Functional Suitability, Usability, Performance Efficiency, and Security. The results will be used to determine the system's quality and overall acceptability as an AI-assisted learning platform.

RESEARCH DESIGN

This study uses a developmental research design with a quantitative approach to guide the design, construction, and evaluation of the LearnSync AI web application. In educational technology, developmental research focuses on the systematic creation, testing, and evaluation of instructional tools to ensure they are stable, functional, and effective (Angeles & Cortez, 2023). By using this design, this project transitions from theoretical software planning to a functional, real-world application tested by its target users. The systematic recording of the design and development processes allows the research team to translate educational needs into functional software features while collecting objective numbers to prove the application's overall performance.

The developmental process for LearnSync AI is structured into three distinct, student-centered phases. The first phase is the analysis and design phase, which focuses on identifying the specific study challenges faced by Grade 10 students during self-paced study. The findings from this initial phase are used to design the user interface layout of the Student Portal, map out the architecture of the private study spaces, establish the Bayesian Knowledge Tracing routing

rules, and draft the mechanics for the "PlayMe" gamification. The second phase is the development phase, which involves the technical implementation of the web application. Key tasks during this period include configuring the Supabase relational database, establishing PostgreSQL Row-Level Security policies to protect individual student data, programming the generative artificial intelligence parser to extract study terms from student uploads, implementing the real-time Bayesian Knowledge Tracing scoring engine, and developing the peer-to-peer sharing utility. The third and final phase of this process is the evaluation phase, which is designed to test the operational quality and students impact of the finished application. The platform will be deployed and evaluated over a 2- to 4-week period involving 18 Grade 10 students from Pasig Christian Academy. During this period, participants will independently use the platform's learning features in a realistic self-study environment. Their experiences and feedback will be collected through a structured evaluation questionnaire to assess the platform's quality and user acceptability.

To objectively evaluate the developed system, the study utilizes quantitative data collected through two complementary methods. The first method involves system-generated operational data, including students' interactions with Adaptive Flashcards and Adaptive Test Mode, where the Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) algorithm continuously estimates learner mastery based on assessment performance. These data are used to validate the operation of the adaptive learning mechanism and verify that the system personalizes learning activities according to students' estimated mastery.

The second method is a software quality evaluation based on the ISO/IEC 25010 software quality model. After using the platform, the student participants will complete a structured evaluation questionnaire using a five-point Likert scale. The collected responses will be analyzed using descriptive statistics to determine the level of acceptability of LearnSync AI in terms of Functional Suitability, Usability, Performance Efficiency, and Security. The results will be used to assess the overall quality and user acceptability of the developed platform.

ARCHITECTURAL FRAMEWORK

The architectural framework of LearnSync AI is structured as a student-centric, three-tier model designed to provide a secure, personal, and highly adaptive self-study environment. The system isolates individual learning activities, processes behavioral tracking parameters, and dynamically scales challenge levels. The system is split into three main layers: the Presentation Layer, the Application Layer, and the Data Tier.

1. **Presentation Layer -** This layer represents the client-facing user interface running natively inside the student's web browser. It serves as the primary gateway for data ingestion while rendering processed data back to the learner. Within this tier, the Study Space Hub handles the direct capture of the student's raw data inputs. This includes the upload of raw PDF documents (up to 20 MB), qualitative memory retrieval ratings recorded

within the flashcard mode (where students rate cards as Easy, Medium, or Hard), unstructured textual inputs for Feynman Technique and Free Recall exercises, and student-configured practice test parameters alongside submitted answers (where students can select one or more test types like multiple choice, identification, matching type, fill in the blank, and true or false). The PlayMe Portal intercepts all user gameplay telemetry, tracking interaction timings and activity logs during Crosswords, Term Matching, and Timed Trivia modules. Finally, the Dashboard Screen manages the visual output stream of the layer, rendering real-time performance analytics, cumulative study hours, active daily streaks, mastery curves, and unlocked milestone badges directly onto the interface.

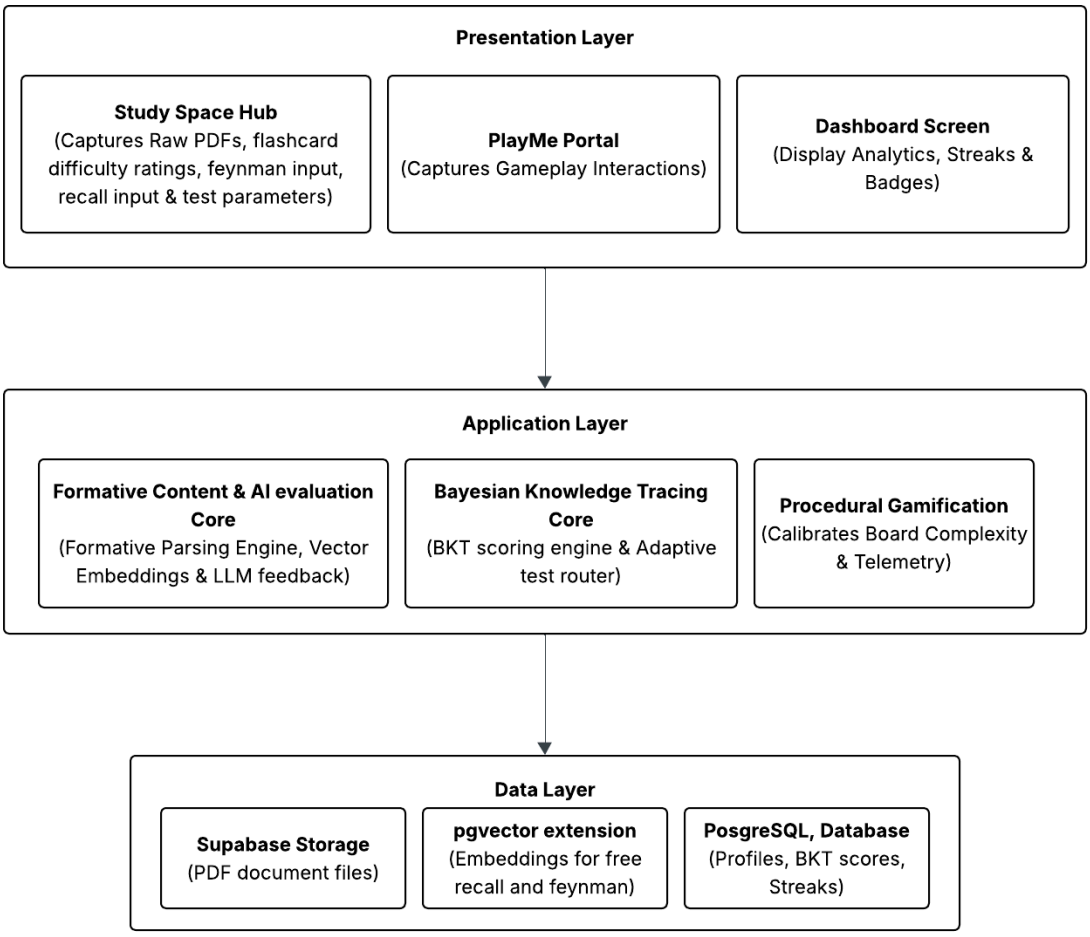
2. **Application Layer -** This layer operates as the central computational brain of LearnSync AI, intercepting the raw data parameters flowing from the user interface and processing them through specialized algorithmic logic cores. The first major component, the Formative Content & AI Evaluation Core, ingests raw student materials via the Formative Parsing Engine to extract glossaries and core concepts, while utilizing Vector Embeddings and large language model (LLM) feedback to analyze Free Recall and Feynman summaries. Positioned alongside this is the Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) Core, which acts as the system's primary cognitive tracking engine. This core processes the ongoing qualitative ratings from the flashcard review sessions and practice test

submissions, converting them into standard binary inputs to mathematically update the student's latent mastery score. The Adaptive Test Router then reads this updated mastery state to instantly scale the difficulty of generated practice test questions up or down. To tie the logic layer together, an algorithmic link feeds this live mastery baseline directly into the Procedural Gamification Engine, enabling it to read the calculated knowledge state as a configuration metric to calibrate board complexity and match game difficulty perfectly to the student's active level of understanding.

3. **Data Tier -** The Data layer coordinates all persistent data operations, storage management, and structural security boundaries across the cloud infrastructure. Powered entirely by a unified Supabase platform, this tier secures and isolates information across three specialized storage vectors. The Supabase Storage engine operates as a secure file-bucket repository that houses raw PDF document files uploaded by students for their respective study spaces. Working in parallel is the pgvector extension, a high-dimensional database module that stores semantic embeddings derived from the student's learning materials to execute fast vector similarity queries for Free Recall evaluations. Lastly, the PostgreSQL Database serves as the structured relational foundation of the entire system, maintaining long-term records of student profiles, updated BKT mastery percentages, and study streak metadata, all while enforcing strict

Row-Level Security (RLS) policies to prevent unauthorized data access across individual user profiles.

Figure 1. *Architectural Framework*



ALGORITHM

This section details the mathematical and algorithmic foundation of LearnSync AI's cognitive modeling core. To deliver a highly personalized, self-directed learning experience, the platform integrates the classical four-parameter Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) model. Originally formalized by Corbett and Anderson (1994) and optimized for modern web architectures using the open-source pyBKT standard (Bulut et al., 2023), BKT operates as a dynamic, hidden Markov model (HMM) with observable nodes. Within LearnSync

AI, this algorithm continuously analyzes a student's sequential interactions to trace their latent knowledge state for any given concept without requiring computationally heavy server resources.

1. **BKT Mathematical Model** - The primary objective of the BKT algorithm is to estimate the hidden probability that a student has mastered a specific concept based on their chronological sequence of correct and incorrect answers. The mathematical framework is governed by four distinct, highly interpretable parameters categorized into two knowledge parameters and two performance parameters:

    a. **Initial Knowledge State** $P(L_0)$: The prior probability that a student already knows or has mastered a concept before interacting with any formative study modes or assessments on the platform.

    b. **Transition Probability** $P(T)$: The learning rate, which represents the probability that a student transitions from an unmastered (not-known) state to a mastered (known) state after experiencing a learning opportunity.

    c. **Guess Probability** $P(G)$: The probability that a student who has not mastered the concept still manages to answer a practice question or flip card correctly.

d. Slip Probability $P(S)$: The probability that a student who has mastered the concept still answers incorrectly due to carelessness, cognitive fatigue, or a reading error.

As the student interacts with the application, their performance at any given learning opportunity *t* is captured as an observable binary variable (obs_t), where an answer is marked as correct ($obs_t = 1$) or incorrect ($obs_t = 0$). When a new observation is captured, the system executes a two-phase Bayesian update. First, the algorithm applies the evidence update phase to calculate the conditional probability of mastery ($P(L_t \mid obs_t)$ based on the observation:

Formula when the students attempt is correct ($obs_t = 1$) :

$$P(L_t \mid obs_t = 1) = \frac{P(L_t)\,(1-P(S))}{P(L_t)\,(1-P(S)) + (1-P(L_t))\,P(G)}$$

Formula when the students attempt is incorrect ($obs_t = 0$) :

$$P(L_t \mid obs_t = 0) = \frac{P(L_t)\,P(S)}{P(L_t)\,P(S) + (1-P(L_t))\,(1-P(G))}$$

Second, the algorithm performs the transition update phase. This step calculates the projected probability of mastery for the subsequent learning opportunity ($P(L_{t+1})$) by factoring in the learning rate ($P(T)$) as the student moves to the next card or question, assuming immediate formative feedback is processed:

$$P(L_{t+1}) = P(L_t \mid obs_t) + (1 - P(L_t \mid obs_t))\,P(T)$$

2. **Algorithmic Implementation in Flashcard Mode -** Within the study space, the spaced repetition manages how the flashcards behaves while bkt calculates the students mastery of a concept. These flashcards can be made by the student or generated by the AI model using the uploaded files. When a student opens a flashcard session, the system loads their current progress from the database. If it is a brand-new card set, the system initializes their score to the standard starting level $P(L_0)$. During study, the student flips a card to reveal its definition and rates how well they remembered it by choosing Easy, Medium, or Hard. Choosing Easy means the student remembered the card easily. The system schedules this card to reappear in four days and records a correct answer $(obs_t = 1)$. To reflect this high confidence, the algorithm drops the guess rate to a very low number $(P(G_{easy}) = 0.05)$. This tells the formula that luck was not involved, giving the student a large boost in their mastery score. Choosing medium means the student remembered the card but had to think about it. The system schedules this card to reappear in three days and also records as correct answer $(obs_t = 1)$. However, to account for the chance that the student got it right by guessing, the algorithm uses a higher guess rate $(P(G_{medium}) = 0.25)$, which gives them a smaller and more cautious boost to their mastery score. Finally, choosing Hard means the student forgot the card. The system schedules

the card to reappear in one day for fast practice and records an incorrect answer $obs_t = 0$. The application sends these ratings directly to the BKT math engine to calculate the student's new progress percentage $P(L_{t+1})$ and saves it in the database. This hybrid setup gives students personalized review times while the BKT engine accurately updates their knowledge statistics behind the scenes.

3. **Algorithmic Implementation in Adaptive test Mode** - Within the adaptive test mode, the Bayesian Knowledge Tracing model serves as the main engine for calibrating the difficulty of generated assessment sessions. When entering Test Mode, the student selects one or more custom question formats, such as multiple choice, identification, matching type, fill in the blank, or true or false. As the student completes their attempts during active testing, their performance is graded as a binary value (1 for correct or 0 for incorrect), and the BKT update pipeline calculates their dynamic mastery score on a per-question basis. This real-time calculated score updates the student's concept-specific history in the central database.

   When the student subsequently requests the generation of a new practice test session on the same topic, the system queries this historical BKT mastery probability to scale the conceptual difficulty of the newly generated items. The adaptive test generation engine utilizes specific

mastery thresholds to adjust the generation prompt instructions sent to the large language model.

If the current running mastery probability is high specifically at or above 0.85, the AI model is instructed to generate advanced-tier questions focusing on analytical scenarios, synthesis, and edge-cases within the student's selected formats. If the mastery probability lies in the intermediate range between 0.50 and 0.85, the prompt parameters dictate intermediate-tier questions emphasizing conceptual comparisons, multi-concept recall, and practical applications. Now, if the running mastery sits in the foundational range below 0.50, the generation instructions shift to produce simpler, highly supportive retrieval questions focusing on direct definitions and basic conceptual associations. This session-based adaptation allows students to retain complete control over their preferred test layouts while the system continuously adjusts the cognitive demands of the content to match their developmental needs.

4. **Document Mastery and Gamification Calibration** - While Bayesian Knowledge Tracing tracks individual concepts as isolated, high-precision knowledge components in the database, the system must provide a consolidated progress index for end-users. When a student uploads a study document, the document ingestion engine parses and extracts a set of *N* distinct concept nodes. To render a high-readability overview on the

student's dashboard, the application layer dynamically aggregates these independent probabilities using an arithmetic mean. The overall mastery rate M_{doc} for an uploaded document containing *N* concepts is calculated at any given timestamp using the most current running BKT metrics fetched from the database:

$$M_{doc} = \frac{\Sigma P(L_{current,i})}{N}$$

Where:

- M_{doc} represents the overall document mastery percentage displayed as a progress bar on the user dashboard.
- N represents the total number of distinct concepts extracted from the uploaded document file.
- $P(L_{current,i})$ represents the real-time, running BKT mastery probability of the i-th concept stored under the student's profile in the database. This value is dynamically calculated for each individual concept *i* through the sequential, chronological application of the core BKT equations detailed in *BKT Mathematical Model.* At the initial state (before any student interactions, where *t* = 0), the concept's probability is initialized to the baseline prior $P(L_0)$.

  For each subsequent practice attempt *t* on that concept, the system captures the binary user interaction response $obs_t = 0$ or

$obs_t = 1$, calculates the intermediate conditional probability using the corresponding evidence formula, and executes the transition update to produce the updated probability state $P(L_{t+1})$. The active value of $P(L_{current,i})$ referenced in this macro aggregation formula represents the most recently computed and saved $P(L_{t+1})$ value stored within the student's concept profile in the database, ensuring that the aggregate overview dynamically adapts to their live learning progress.

This aggregated score is directly utilized by the system's gamification module to calibrate the operational difficulty of generated games (crosswords, term matching, and timed trivia). When a game session is initialized, the system retrieves the current M_{doc} value from the database and applies it as a baseline parameter to the generative AI prompt. For example, if a student's document mastery sits at exactly 50%, the game engine utilizes this value to restrict the vocabulary complexity, clue difficulty, and trivia response timers to align exactly with that 50% knowledge threshold. This integration protects students from cognitive frustration while keeping gamified learning tightly synchronized with their cognitive progress.

5. **Evaluation in Free Recall** - Within the study spaces, the Free Recall tab lets students type out everything they can remember about a lesson without looking at their notes. To grade this automatically, the system uses

a method called Cosine Similarity which is calculated natively inside the database using the Supabase pgvector extension. This database-level calculation removes the need for complex mathematical scripts in the application's backend code by computing vector geometry directly on the cloud server.

When a student uploads their study materials, the application breaks the document into small pieces and converts those pieces into lists of numbers called high-dimensional vector embeddings that capture their exact meaning. When the student types out their recall summary, the system converts their typed text into a vector too.

Instead of running slow calculations on the backend application layer, the backend simply sends the student's vector to Supabase. The database natively calculates the mathematical angle between the student's typed vector $\vec{A}$ and the lesson's stored vector $\vec{B}$ using the Cosine Distance Operator <=>, where the final Cosine Similarity is found through the simple subtraction formula:

$$Cosine\ Similarity\ =\ 1\ -\ (A\ <=>\ B)$$

If the database returns a score close to 1, it means the student's written ideas point in the same directional meaning as the lesson. If the similarity score falls below a set quality threshold (such as 0.75), the system identifies that a gap exists. The system then compares the student's typed text directly against the lesson's key glossary terms to spot exactly which

keywords were missing, displaying this feedback immediately to the student so they know what to review.

6. **Feedback generation in Feynman Technique** - The Feynman Technique helps students learn by explaining hard topics in simple, everyday language, as if they are teaching a five-year-old child. To evaluate how well a student does this, the application guides a large language model (LLM) through a three-step evaluation pipeline.

   The first step is the Jargon Check. The AI scans the student's written explanation and compares it against the main glossary list extracted during the document upload phase. If the student uses highly complex terms (like "photosynthesis" or "electromagnetism") without breaking them down simply, the AI flags those words and tells the student they need to explain them in simpler terms.

   The second step is Analogy Verification. The AI checks if the student used a helpful comparison or everyday story (an analogy) to make the idea clear. For example, when explaining electrical circuits, the AI checks if the student compared it to water flowing through pipes to make the concept easier to grasp.

   The third and final step is Finding the Gaps. The AI compares the student's simple explanation to the original study text to make sure they did not make a factual error or skip an important step. If the student made

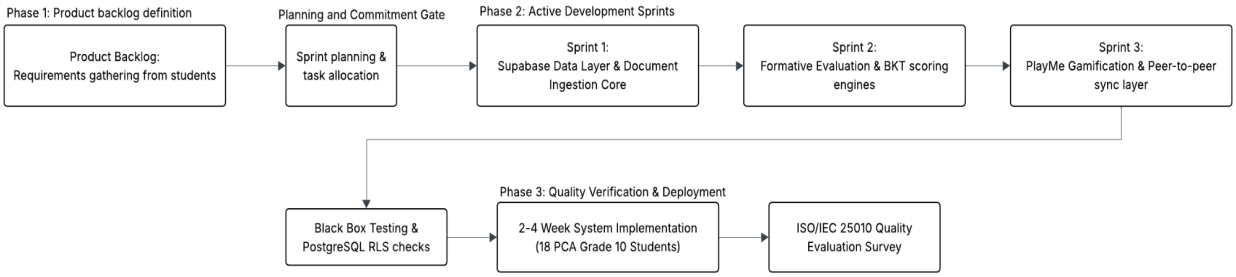
a mistake, the AI does not just give them a low grade. Instead, it acts like a curious child and asks simple, guiding questions (such as, "But how does the water get up into the sky in the first place?") to help the student find and correct their own learning gaps.

SE PARADIGM

This study utilizes the Agile Scrum framework to guide the design, development, and implementation of LearnSync AI. Since the platform includes several interconnected features that require continuous testing and improvement, a flexible software development methodology is needed. Agile Scrum supports iterative development through short sprint cycles, allowing developers to continuously build, test, and refine the system while responding to changing requirements and user feedback (Schwaber & Sutherland, 2020; Kuhrmann et al., 2021).

Using Agile Scrum also enables the researchers to identify and resolve issues early in the development process, resulting in better software quality and reduced development risks (Strode et al., 2022). This approach ensures that LearnSync AI is developed efficiently while meeting both user needs and system requirements.

Figure 2. *Agile SDLC*



The execution of the Agile Scrum framework across the development lifecycle is structured into the following sequential phases:

1. **Phase 1: Product Backlog** - During this initial phase, the research team establishes the master list of software requirements from the perspective of the system's single user role: the student. These requirements are formalized as specific functional specifications to keep the development process aligned with the needs of the students. The students must be able to create secure, private study spaces where they can upload text-only reference PDFs (maximum 20 MB) to act as custom knowledge repositories. Additionally, students should have access to four self-paced study options within their space container, including adaptive flashcards ,free Recall with AI-generated feedback, Feynman Technique explanations, and an AI-driven course resource chatbot. For structured evaluations, students need the ability to generate customized, adaptive practice tests of various formats (multiple-choice, matching, fill-in-the-blank,

identification, and true/false) that scale in difficulty based on their real-time BKT mastery state. Finally, the student backlog mandates a gamified study review engine containing crosswords, matching cards, and timed trivia that dynamically adjust in difficulty using the student's BKT scores, alongside a secure peer-to-peer sharing utility where students can share their spaces for read-only peer viewing.

2. **Planning and Commitment Stage** - Before committing to code generation, the development team transition requirements through a strict Planning and Commitment Gate. In this collaborative phase, the team conducts sprint planning sessions to break down the product backlog specifications into modular, highly actionable engineering tasks. This process includes estimating developmental complexities, designating feature priorities, allocating tasks among programmers, and establishing a strict sprint calendar. By establishing clear commitments at this stage, the team ensures that the development cycles remain tightly focused, preventing scope creep and ensuring that high-risk mathematical models and data security layers are prioritized before active coding begins.

3. **Phase 2: Active Development Sprints -** The second phase represents the core coding lifecycle of the application, structured into three distinct, iterative sprints:

    a. **Sprint 1: Supabase Data Layer & Document Ingestion Core**: This sprint focuses entirely on establishing the core cloud infrastructure, database schemas, and text-parsing pipelines needed to handle student document uploads. The development team configures the PostgreSQL tables on Supabase to house the structural components of the data stores, including the parent study spaces tables and the child learning materials and embeddings records. Strict PostgreSQL Row-Level Security (RLS) policies are enforced to guarantee that each student's profile data, study materials, and metrics remain completely private and isolated under their unique authenticated user ID. Finally, the team implements text extraction scripts using large language models to read uploaded PDFs, extract concepts & definitions, and generate semantic vectors, saving the parsed results directly into the database.

b. **Sprint 2: Formative Evaluation & BKT Scoring Engines**: This sprint builds the active learning algorithms, the predictive cognitive modeling engine, and the Generative AI evaluation services. The software team programs the classical four-parameter Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) scoring calculations to dynamically track the latent knowledge state of the student after each question attempt (0 for incorrect, 1 for correct), updating the mastery profiles in the tracking database. The team develops the routing algorithm that queries these baseline metrics and dynamically adjusts the difficulty of generated test questions to match the student's current conceptual limits. The development phase also establishes the semantic evaluation queries utilizing vector databases to calculate similarity thresholds for Free Recall text inputs, integrates the language model prompt templates to evaluate Feynman simple-terms explanations and chatbot queries, and logs the activity transaction timestamps directly into the unified Activity and Streak Logs database to track daily engagement.

c. **Sprint 3: PlayMe Gamification & Peer-to-Peer Sync Layer**: This sprint focuses on the motivational design,

peer-to-peer workspace sharing, and the user interface layout. The developer team codes the backtracking layout algorithm that dynamically structures crossword grids, trivia questions, and vocabulary matches based on the parsed glossaries, using the student's BKT score as a difficulty reference. The gamification and streak engine evaluates a unified database log of both active study space reviews and game sessions to validate milestone badge criteria (such as a badge for reaching a 10-day streak) and check daily study log timestamps to manage and update active consecutive daily streaks. The collaboration logic is programmed to generate secure synchronization tokens and configure read-only database permission layers to allow classmates to safely clone spaces. The sprint concludes by compiling the backend API gateways and real-time database channels with a responsive, single-role web frontend student interface.

4. **Phase 3: Quality Verification & Development** - During this phase, the completed LearnSync AI web application is subjected to rigorous testing and validation procedures to ensure absolute stability and performance before classroom rollout. The phase initiates with extensive Black Box Testing and PostgreSQL Row-Level Security checks, designed to verify that the core system

modules operate with complete technical accuracy. These procedures confirm that PostgreSQL database permission layers successfully isolate data, preventing student accounts from reading, editing, or deleting unauthorized classmates' spaces. Following structural security and algorithmic validation, the web application is formally launched for a live, 2 to 4 implementation of 18 Grade 10 students at Pasig Christian Academy. These students independently use the web platform to study and review their actual secondary education curriculum materials outside the classroom, providing a realistic independent learning environment for evaluating the platform's functionality and user experience. At the conclusion of this implementation, a structured software quality survey is administered to the participating students. This evaluation tool translates user experience feedback into objective, numerical averages using a 4-point Likert scale to formally measure and verify the application’s overall operational quality across four core software criteria, specifically evaluating its Functional Suitability, Usability, Performance Efficiency, and Security under the standardized ISO/IEC 25010 framework.

DATA FLOW DIAGRAM

This section defines the LearnSync AI’s Data Flow Diagrams (DFDs). These visual models map the recursive flow of course materials, study

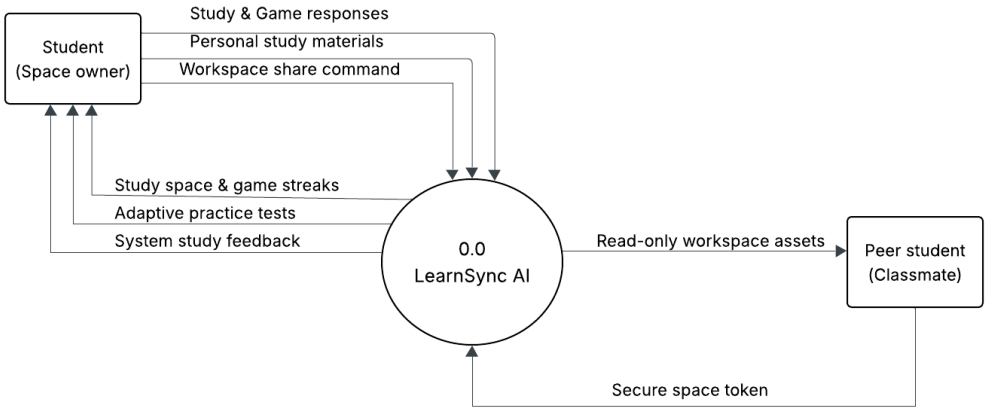
responses, and gamified data, charting how information moves seamlessly from raw ingestion to the generation of adaptive assessment questions and real-time learning analytics

1. **Level 0: Context Diagram -** When using the system, the Student (Space owner) sends three main types of inputs into the LearnSync AI platform. First, they provide Study & Game responses, which are the active clicks and typing they do while reviewing. This includes rating card retrieval difficulty (by choosing Easy, Medium, or Hard) during flashcard reviews, typing out summaries for recall exercises, and interacting with study games. Second, they upload their Personal study materials, which are PDF files up to 20 MB containing the student's lessons, textbooks, or notes. Lastly, they send the Workspace share command, which is just the user clicking a button in the app to make their private workspace public so a classmate can view it.

   In return, the platform delivers three main types of outputs back to the Student (Space owner). The Study space & game streaks are live screen updates that show their total study hours, daily streaks, and digital badges. The Adaptive practice tests are customized quizzes that automatically get easier or harder depending on how well the student understands the topic. Finally, the System study feedback provides simple, helpful advice on their progress, showing them what key terms they missed during active recall or confirming if their simplified explanations make logical sense.

The Peer student (Classmate) interacts with the system using two simple data flows. To view a shared workspace, they must first send a Secure space token, which is a unique link or access code that acts as a secure passkey. Once the system checks and verifies this code, it displays the Read-only workspace assets on their screen. This data flow allows the classmate to read and study the shared flashcards, summaries, and documents. Crucially, this access is strictly view-only, meaning the peer student can read the materials but cannot edit them or copy the setup into their own account.

Figure 3. *Level 0 Context Diagram*



2. **Level 1: Date flow diagram -** the system's internal work is divided into five separate sub-processes, three database storage areas (called data stores), and two groups of users: the Student (Space owner) and the Peer

Student (Classmate). By splitting the system this way, the diagram shows how uploading files, reading text with AI, and tracking learning progress all work together securely.

The first sub-process, 1.0 Space Access and Space sharing Control, handles the privacy settings of study spaces and controls how students share their work with classmates. When a Student (Space owner) wants to share a study space, they trigger a Workspace share command. This tells the process to create a secure key and run a Space configuration update & token query to save that key in the Study spaces, Learning materials and Embeddings data store. When a Peer Student (Classmate) wants to view this shared space, they enter a Secure Space token. The process sends this token to the database, which replies with a Space sharing status response to confirm the key is correct. Once verified, Process 1.0 displays the Read-only study space on the classmate's screen. This ensures classmates can study the shared materials but cannot edit, delete, or change any of the original student's files.

The second sub-process, 2.0 Document Parsing and Semantic Ingestion, manages how new study files are uploaded and prepared. When a Student (Space owner) uploads their Personal Study Materials (as a PDF up to 20 MB) inside a study space, this process reads the document. It finds the main keywords, creates a glossary list, and converts the sentences into a math format that AI can read. It then saves these results directly to the Study spaces, Learning materials and Embeddings

data store using the Parsed text, keywords and vectors data flow. The system automatically links every uploaded file and keyword list to the main study space's ID, making sure the materials are immediately organized and ready for the student to practice with.

The third sub-process, 3.0 Formative Study and AI Evaluation, runs the non-graded review activities like the Feynman Technique, Free Recall, flashcard generation, and chatbot interactions. When the Student (Space owner) inputs their Formative responses & chatbot queries (such as asking questions to the AI, summarizing topics, or rating flipped flashcard difficulty as Easy, Medium, or Hard), the process pulls the original Parsed Content from the Study spaces, Learning materials and Embeddings data store. Using AI, the process calculates how much of the topic the student successfully remembered, provides immediate answers, and sends back System feedback & chatbot responses to the user's interface. To handle interactive flashcards, this process reads the student's history using the Current flashcard mastery flow from the Student Profiles and Mastery Track database. It converts the student's qualitative ratings (Easy and Medium as a correct recall, and Hard as an incorrect recall) into standard binary observations $(obs_t = 1)$ or $(obs_t = 0)$. It also routes the correct rating classification (such as mapping Easy to a low guess rate of 0.05 and Medium to a moderate guess rate of 0.25) into the update pipeline, updates it using the Flashcard BKT metrics update flow, and saves the updated states back to the database. When the student finishes reviewing,

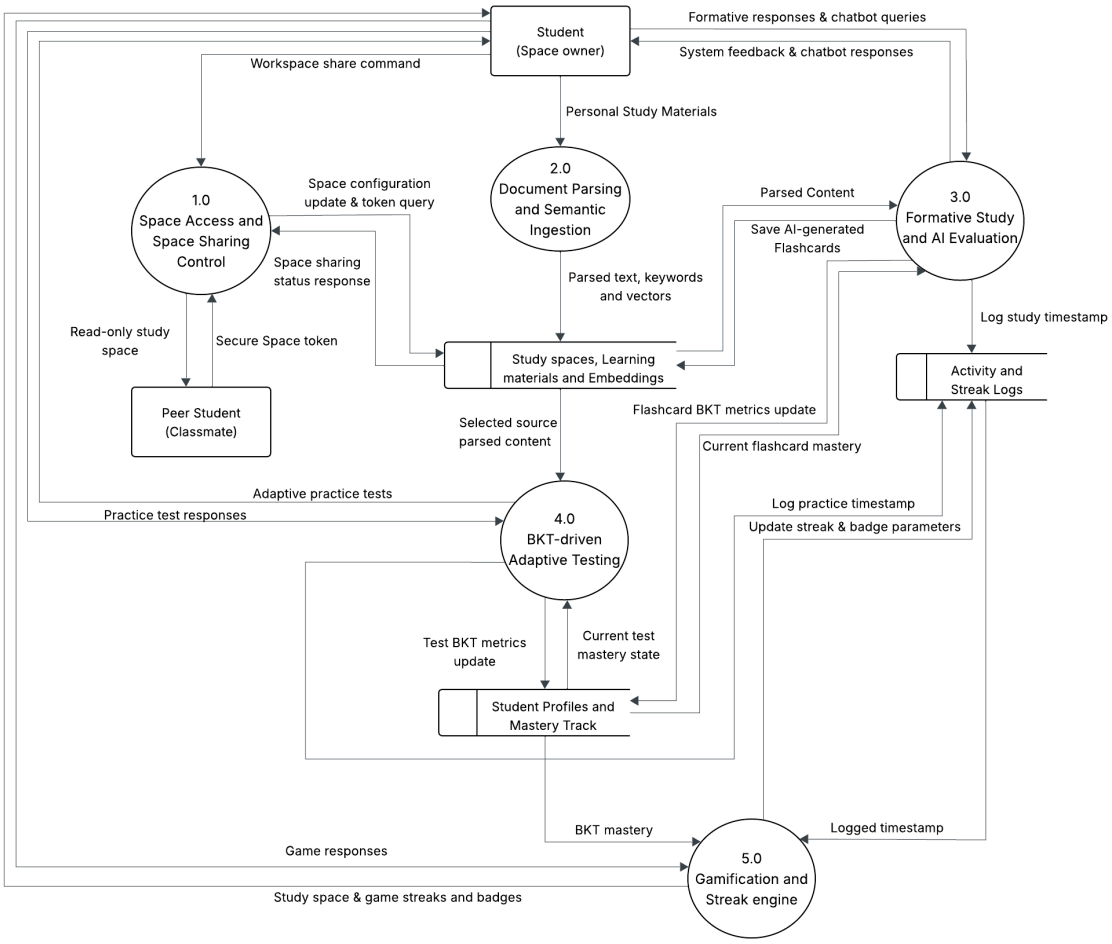
the process sends a Log study timestamp to the Activity and Streak Logs data store to record that they studied.

The fourth sub-process, 4.0 BKT-driven Adaptive Testing, serves as the main center for grading practice tests and choosing the next questions. When the Student (Space owner) answers multiple-choice questions or flashcards, their answers are captured as Practice test responses (marked as a 1 for correct or a 0 for incorrect). The process retrieves the original study files using the Selected source parsed content flow from the Study spaces, Learning materials and Embeddings data store, and reads the student's learning history using the Current test mastery state flow from the Student Profiles and Mastery Track data store. Using the Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) math model, the process calculates what the student knows and automatically sends back Adaptive practice tests with harder or easier questions. At the same time, it updates the student's profile in the database using the Test BKT metrics update flow and saves the test time in the Activity and Streak Logs database using a Log practice timestamp.

The fifth and final sub-process, 5.0 Gamification and Streak engine, keeps students motivated by awarding badges and study streaks without affecting their actual test scores. When the Student (Space owner) plays study games, their actions are sent as Game responses. To make sure the games match the student's skills, the process reads their learning level from the Student Profiles and Mastery Track database using the BKT

mastery flow as a reference to adjust game difficulty. It also reads study times from the Activity and Streak Logs database using the Logged timestamp flow to check if the student has studied within a daily calendar window. The engine then updates the student's streak records using the Update streak & badge parameters flow and displays their updated Study space & game streaks and badges (such as active days, and earned badges) right on their dashboard screen.

Figure 4. *Level 1 Main Process*



TOOL TO TEST FOR ACCURACY

This study uses a specialized testing framework to verify that LearnSync AI's learning and grading modules work accurately, securely, and reliably. Because the platform relies on real-time artificial intelligence and probability calculations rather than simple, fixed question sets, traditional software testing is not enough. The research team must isolate both the math engine and the AI generators to verify that the system tracks student progress correctly, routes

questions appropriately, and keeps user data secure before the application is deployed in a live classroom.

To measure how well the application tracks student learning progress, the backend math engine undergoes rigorous offline testing. This step simulates student interactions using pre-recorded study histories to check if the algorithm can accurately predict whether a student has mastered a topic or is still struggling.

1. **Confusion Matrix for Students Mastery** - The system predicts a student's learning state using a simple "Mastered" versus "Not Mastered" classification. To evaluate how accurate these predictions are, the research team uses a confusion matrix. This matrix acts as a diagnostic report card, comparing the system's prediction against how the student actually performs on subsequent practice questions. The results are grouped into four clear outcomes:

    - **True Positive** (TP) : The system predicts that the student has mastered a concept, and the student proves this correct by answering the next question correctly.

    - **True Negative** (TN) : The system predicts that the student has not yet mastered a concept, and the student confirms this by answering the next question incorrectly (pointing out an active learning gap).

- **False Positive** (FP) : The system incorrectly predicts that the student has mastered a concept, but the student gets the next question wrong because the material is actually too difficult.
- **False Negative** (FN) : The system incorrectly predicts that the student is struggling, but the student gets the next question right because they actually understand the concept.

This confusion matrix is chosen because evaluating the system's decisions using a basic average percentage is not enough. A simple average hides the exact nature of the system's errors. By separating these four outcomes, the research team can verify that the system's mastery boundaries are highly optimized.

From these outcomes, the development team calculates standard testing metrics. Precision measures the system's reliability, ensuring that when the application claims a student has mastered a topic, that claim is highly trustworthy (minimizing false alarms that push students into frustratingly difficult questions):

$$Precision = \frac{TP}{TP + FP}$$

Conversely, Recall measures the system's sensitivity, ensuring that the application successfully catches every student who is genuinely struggling so that no active learning gaps are ignored (minimizing missed opportunities that trap students in boring, repetitive lessons):

$$Recall = \frac{TP}{TP + FN}$$

To measure the overall balance between reliability and sensitivity, the team calculates the harmonic mean of precision and recall, yielding the F1-Score:

$$F_1 = 2\,x\,\frac{Precision\,x\,Recall}{Precision + Recall}$$

2. **Cognitive Tracking Accuracy via Mean Absolute Error** (MAE) - While the confusion matrix checks high-level, yes-or-no mastery decisions, Mean Absolute Error (MAE) measures the accuracy of the shifting percentages calculated inside the Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) engine. Learning is not a simple, linear process; a student's level of understanding rises and falls continuously. MAE acts like a statistical tape measure, calculating the average mathematical distance between the system's predicted probability of a student answering correctly and the student's actual, real-world outcome ($obs_t \in \{0, 1\}$)

   MAE is selected as a companion metric to the confusion matrix because it evaluates the fine-grained math updates happening inside the algorithm. It calculates how close the system's percentage guesses are to real-world outcomes. Averaging these absolute errors across the entire dataset provides a transparent, unweighted measurement of prediction error.

The MAE across a series of *M* total student practice attempts is calculated using the following formula:

$$MAE = \frac{\Sigma P(osb_t = 1) - obs_t}{M}$$

Where:

- *M* represents the total number of sequential practice attempts evaluated across the study sessions.
- $P(obs_t = 1)$ represents the algorithm's predicted probability that the student will answer correctly at learning opportunity t, calculated as:

$$P(obs_t = 1) = P(L_t)(1 - P(S)) + (1 - P(L_t))P(G)$$

- obs_t represents the actual, real-world outcome of the student's attempt, where a correct response is recorded as 1 and an incorrect response is recorded as 0.

By keeping the baseline MAE as close to zero as possible during system testing, the engineering team prevents the math engine from drifting and ensures that the app's internal cognitive tracker closely mirrors the actual learning speeds of real students.

3. **Black-Box Functional and Security Testing** - In addition to validating the mathematical models, the development team conducts black-box testing. This method evaluates the system's inputs and outputs without needing to inspect the underlying source code. Semantic parser testing verifies that when a student uploads a standard, text-only PDF study module, the system successfully extracts a clean, organized list of key terms and questions matching the database layout without any broken characters. In parallel, database query validation checks the system's search operators to ensure that semantic vector searches accurately match user search queries with relevant study content during Free Recall activities. To verify the adaptive intelligence layer, routing logic testing confirms that a sequence of incorrect answers successfully lowers the student's BKT score and prompts the AI generator to route the student to simpler, foundational-tier questions. To ensure data safety, peer-to-peer sharing permission validation checks that security rules on database storage buckets function perfectly, confirming that when a student uses a shared token to view a classmate's study space, they are strictly locked out from editing, deleting, or altering any materials. Finally, role-based access and isolation testing verifies that database policies completely isolate individual user accounts, ensuring that a logged-in student can only view, create, or update data tied to their unique, verified user ID, making it impossible for classmates to access another student's private study metrics.

4. **ISO/IEC 25010 Quality Model Survey** - The technical testing phase concludes with a software quality evaluation. Grounded in the standardized ISO/IEC 25010 Software Quality Model, this descriptive evaluation is administered to the 18 Grade 10 students at Pasig Christian Academy after they use the application. The evaluation gathers student feedback to measure the platform's production-readiness across four key areas, starting with functional suitability to measure how completely and accurately the system's features, such as adaptive tests, memory recall feedback, and peer-to-peer resource sharing, meet the students' actual self-study needs. The second area, usability, evaluates user interface clarity, ease of navigation, and whether the gamification makes learning engaging without causing unnecessary mental strain. Additionally, performance efficiency measures the speed of the application, tracking database update times and the responsiveness of the AI during feedback generation. The evaluation concludes with security, which formally verifies student privacy, the absolute isolation of user profiles, and the integrity of read-only permissions during peer-to-peer resource sharing sessions.

POPULATION AND SAMPLING

The target population of this study consists of the 18 Grade 10 students of Pasig Christian Academy for the Academic Year 2026–2027. Grade 10 students were selected because they are preparing for the transition to Senior High

School, where strengthening academic readiness and independent learning is important. As the intended users of LearnSync AI, they will evaluate the system based on their experience using its personalized learning features.

Since the study involves all Grade 10 students in the institution, the researchers will use Total Population Sampling, a type of purposive sampling in which all members of the target population are included as participants. The whole 1 section of 18 Grade 10 students will serve as the primary respondents during the system implementation and evaluation, using the platform's learning features, including Adaptive Flashcards, Adaptive Test Mode, AI-assisted study strategies, educational games, and peer-to-peer resource sharing.

EVALUATION INSTRUMENT

The primary evaluation instruments of this study consist of researcher-developed questionnaires designed to evaluate LearnSync AI based on its perceived effectiveness and software quality. The questionnaires are divided into two sections. The first section measures the platform's perceived effectiveness in promoting student engagement and supporting independent learning through its AI-assisted learning features, adaptive learning methods, gamification, and peer-to-peer resource sharing. The second section is based on the ISO/IEC 25010 Software Quality Model, which evaluates the system in terms of Functional Suitability, Usability, Performance Efficiency, and Security. These

quality characteristics were selected because they are appropriate for assessing the overall functionality, reliability, and user experience of the platform.

The instrument is divided into two distinct components to capture both quantitative benchmarks and qualitative insights from the 18 Grade 10 respondents:

- **Quantitative Matrix:** This section contains close-ended indicators distributed across the core technical domains. Each indicator maps to the system's operational features, such as the processing efficiency of the AI flashcard parsing engine and the layout stability of the side-by-side study spaces. To evaluate these indicators, respondents rate each item using a structured, forced-choice 4-point rating scale. This scale eliminates a neutral midpoint to ensure definitive data, utilizing the following criteria:

    - **4 – Strongly Agree (SA) / Excellent:** The system attribute functions perfectly, providing exceptional utility, high security, and seamless navigation.
    - **3 – Agree (A) / Good:** The system attribute meets all technical requirements and operates efficiently with minor or negligible usability friction.

    - **2 – Disagree (D) / Fair:** The system attribute meets minimum requirements but exhibits notable performance lags or unintuitive interface layouts.
    - **1 – Strongly Disagree (SD) / Poor:** The system attribute fails to meet baseline operational standards, presenting critical errors or complete layout failures.

- **Qualitative Feedback Loop:** The final section consists of open-ended questions that allow respondents to provide comments, suggestions, and observations regarding the platform. This feedback enables participants to report software issues, usability concerns, feature recommendations, and other experiences that may not be fully captured through the quantitative ratings.

DATA COLLECTION METHOD

Data will be collected through a structured three-phase process consisting of pre-implementation, system implementation, and post-implementation evaluation. The researcher-developed questionnaires for perceived effectiveness and ISO/IEC 25010 software quality evaluation will be administered using Google Forms and facilitated personally by the researchers at Pasig Christian Academy. Conducting the data collection in person ensures that respondents receive

consistent instructions, complete the activities under similar conditions, and have the opportunity to ask questions throughout the implementation period.

During the first phase, the researchers will secure the necessary permissions from the school administration and explain the purpose, objectives, and procedures of the study to the participants. Informed consent will be obtained before the implementation begins, and students will be given instructions on how to access and use LearnSync AI.

During the second phase, the 18 Grade 10 student participants will use LearnSync AI over a two- to four-week implementation period as part of their independent study. They will interact with the platform's learning features, including Adaptive Flashcards, Adaptive Test Mode, AI-assisted learning strategies (Feynman Technique and Free Recall), AI-generated educational games, learning analytics, and peer-to-peer resource sharing. Throughout the implementation, the researchers will monitor the system's operation and provide technical assistance when necessary.

During the final phase, the participants will complete the researcher-developed evaluation questionnaires. The first questionnaire will measure the perceived effectiveness of LearnSync AI in promoting student engagement and supporting independent learning through its personalized learning features. The second questionnaire will evaluate the system based on the ISO/IEC 25010 software quality characteristics of Functional Suitability, Usability, Performance Efficiency, and Security. An open-ended feedback section

will also be included to gather respondents' comments, suggestions, and recommendations for improving the platform.

The responses collected through Google Forms will be automatically recorded and organized for statistical analysis. The questionnaire responses will be used to determine the perceived effectiveness and overall software quality of LearnSync AI, while the qualitative feedback will provide additional insights for future system improvements.

ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

This study will be conducted in accordance with ethical research principles to protect the rights, privacy, and welfare of all participants. Prior to the implementation of LearnSync AI, permission will be obtained from the administration of Pasig Christian Academy, and informed consent will be secured from the participating Grade 10 students and their parents or guardians, when required. Participants will be informed of the purpose of the study, the procedures involved, and their right to withdraw from the study at any time without penalty.

The study will comply with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173) by collecting only the information necessary for system operation and research purposes. Personal and academic information will be treated as confidential and will be used only for evaluating LearnSync AI. The collected data will be securely stored, and access will be limited to the researchers. No

personally identifiable information will be disclosed in any reports or publications resulting from the study.

LearnSync AI also incorporates security measures to protect student information. The platform ensures that users can access only their own personal records and learning progress, while resources shared through the peer-to-peer feature remain under the control of the original owner. Shared materials may be viewed only by authorized users and cannot be modified by other students.

All collected data will be used exclusively for academic research and system evaluation and will not be shared, sold, or disclosed to third parties.

SUMMARY

This chapter presented the research methodology used in the development and evaluation of LearnSync AI, an educational platform with Artificial Intelligence integration designed to support the independent learning of Grade 10 students. It discussed the research design, system architecture, software engineering methodology, research locale, population and sampling, evaluation instruments, data collection procedures, system validation methods, statistical treatment of data, and ethical considerations that guided the conduct of the study.

The study adopted a developmental research design with a quantitative approach to guide the analysis, design, development, implementation, and

evaluation of the proposed system. LearnSync AI was developed using the Agile Scrum software development methodology and incorporates Bayesian Knowledge Tracing (BKT) to estimate students' mastery levels. Adaptive Flashcards and Adaptive Test Mode continuously update students' estimated mastery, while AI-assisted learning strategies, educational games, and personalized feedback utilize the learner's current mastery estimate to support independent learning.

The study will be conducted at Pasig Christian Academy with 18 Grade 10 students selected through Total Population Sampling. The system will be implemented over a two- to four-week period, during which participants will use the platform's personalized learning features as part of their independent study. Data will be collected through researcher-developed questionnaires measuring the perceived effectiveness of LearnSync AI and its software quality based on the ISO/IEC 25010 Software Quality Model, specifically evaluating Functional Suitability, Usability, Performance Efficiency, and Security. In addition, the Bayesian Knowledge Tracing algorithm will be validated using appropriate accuracy measures, including the Confusion Matrix, Precision, Recall, F1-Score, and Mean Absolute Error (MAE), while black-box testing will be conducted to verify the correctness and security of the system's functional components. Appropriate statistical tools will be used to analyze the collected data, and ethical principles, including compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173), will be observed throughout the conduct of the study.

Overall, the methodology presented in this chapter provides a comprehensive framework for evaluating the technical accuracy, perceived effectiveness, and software quality of LearnSync AI as an integrated educational platform that supports the independent learning of Grade 10 students.

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